

Claudia Schou

Dynamic marketing and communications professional with 20 years of experience in brand communications. Proven track record of leading award-winning campaigns that enhance brand affinity and deliver ROI. Skilled in brand storytelling, executive visibility, media relations, brand events and creator campaigns. Passionate leader and motivator focused on collaboration and empowerment.

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EDUCATION

California State University, Fullerton — BA Communications

GRADUATION: JUNE 2003

EXPERIENCE

El Encanto, A Belmond Hotel — Santa Barbara Marketing and Communications Manager September 2023 – July 2025

- Spearheaded integrated marketing campaigns that contributed to 20% YoY increase in direct bookings, reducing reliance on OTAs and improving profit margins that supported revenue growth across leisure, group, and F&B segments.
- Managed budgets for digital/print advertising, collateral development, PR, photography, and social media content creation.
- Initiated Travel Ad campaign that yielded an average ROI of 12:1 with targeted offers driving 18% total direct bookings during off-peak periods.
- Launched seasonal campaigns and in-house activations that drove a 30% YoY increase in leisure, group and celebrations bookings.
- Strengthened the hotel's brand presence through strategic community partnerships and media placements, resulting in increased local engagement and new sales opportunities.
- Created content plans aligned with in-house activations and Leisure/Group sales promotions to maximize conversion and revenue impact.
- Created and curated targeted B2B and B2C email campaigns, driving measurable increases in group leads, direct bookings and newsletter open rates by over 25%.

SKILLS

Brand Marketing
Sales + Marketing Strategy
Reporting
Multi-Channel Marketing
Data-Driven Content
Development
Public Relations
Partnerships
Collateral Development +
Management
Social Media + Influencer
Storytelling
Print + Digital Advertising
SEO + Digital Marketing
Google Analytics
Email Marketing (Clairvoyix)

AWARDS

Sunset Magazine Travel
Award for Top California Spas
- El Encanto · Feb 2024

Platinum Award-Best
Integrated Marketing
Campaign for Hilton's
California Road Trip-Issued
by Hospitality Sales +
Marketing Association
International · Jan 2018

Media Boutique – Santa Barbara

Director of Marketing + Communications

March 2020 – September 2023

- Developed and executed PR and marketing strategies that generated new business acquisition and boosted visibility in competitive markets for high-profile clients including San Ysidro Ranch, Montecito Club, ZSupply Clothing, San Diablo Churro Co., and United Grain Corp.
 - At San Ysidro Ranch and Montecito Club: Oversaw website launches, digital and print advertising, and collateral development, ensuring brand consistency across channels.
 - Led strategic marketing and PR initiatives that elevated Z Supply's brand visibility across fashion media such as *Who What Wear* and influencers, resulting in a 22% increase in wholesale orders and 30% uptick in e-commerce sales.
 - For San Ysidro Ranch, I secured top-tier media placements in *Travel + Leisure*, *Architectural Digest*, *Elle*, *Bloomberg Business*, and more, resulting in a 12% spike in organic bookings following publication.
 - Launched a national ad campaign and influencer initiative for San Ysidro Ranch that drove \$400K in direct bookings in just 3 months.
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**Stars of the Industry Award
for Guest Relations/Public
Relations Campaign for
Center of SoCal-Random Acts
of Summer–Issued by
California Hotels + Lodging
Association · Feb 2015**

Mar Monte Hotel – The Unbound Collection by Hyatt – Santa Barbara

Group Sales Manager

July 2019 – March 2020

- Led sales during the hotel's rebrand, developing tailored proposals and packages for SMERF, corporate, and wedding segments (60–120 room blocks).
 - Negotiated and secured group bookings that contributed to strong ADR and RevPAR performance.
 - Successfully rebooked 80% of group contracts during pre-pandemic cancellations, preserving over \$500K in projected revenue.
 - Drove F&B and event sales by creating cross-departmental collaborations between sales, catering, and marketing.
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Hilton Hotels + Resorts – Anaheim & Santa Barbara

Marketing and Communications Manager

January 2015 – July 2019

- Directed marketing initiatives across Hilton Anaheim and Hilton Santa Barbara Beachfront Resort, with a focus on unique and authentic guest experiences and driving sales pipeline through integrated campaigns.
- Managed all aspects of the brand transition from The Fess Parker to Hilton Santa Barbara Beachfront Resort, including sales collateral,

signage, and digital content.

- Developed multi-channel marketing strategies that generated \$1.5M in group and event sales pipeline through direct response campaigns and targeted outreach.
- Launched a website redesign and SEO strategy that grew direct website traffic by 30% and increased conversion rate by 28%.

Media Boutique – Long Beach

Principal

January 2005 – January 2015

- Led marketing, branding, and PR campaigns for 30+ clients across hospitality, food + beverage, health/wellness, fashion, retail, non-profit and automotive industries.
- Clients included: ParisPerfect.com, Casa Resorts Inc., Me-Ality Apparel Technology, The Melting Pot (NorCal + SoCal), Wine of the Month Club, Crevier BMW, Raj Swim, Swim Spot, Brain and Spine Surgeons of Orange County, Aesthetic Eye Institute, Coastal Kids Pediatric Medical Group, Music Heals Foundation, and others.
- Secured consistent, high-impact media coverage across *The New York Times*, *Today*, *Elle*, *CNN*, *KTLA*, *Modern Luxury*, and *Good Housekeeping*.
- Built trusted media relationships resulting in a 40% year-over-year increase in earned media coverage.
- Created campaigns that directly contributed to increased bookings, brand awareness, and market share growth for hospitality and lifestyle clients.